



Visitor Restrictions and Anonymity Request

1. Scope

Site	Operational Area	Applicable to
Armadale Kalamunda Group	HIMS Nursing / Clinical	Clerical All Areas

2. Purpose

To ensure the safety, privacy and wellbeing of patients, staff and visitors by restricting visitor access **or** designating patients as anonymous.

This procedure outlines how clerical staff update anonymity or visitor restrictions settings.

3. Procedure

3.1 Anonymity

- Patients who require confidentiality such as high-profile individuals, prisoners or children in alternate care can be recorded as anonymous in WebPAS preventing the release of any information regarding their admission or condition.
- Prisoners **must** have their information suppressed during **all** attendances to the health service with no exception as per the [East Metropolitan Health Service, Prisoners and Detainees: Management](#) policy.
- Patients or their guardian may voluntarily request to be listed as anonymous and can revoke this anonymity at any time
- Anonymity is event specific. It is the responsibility of the Patient, Next of Kin, Carer or Guardian to request anonymity for any future hospital visits.
- The health service may enforce anonymity at its discretion if the patient's presentation poses significant risk to the patient or staff.

3.1.1 Activating Anonymity

- Clerk to print [Anonymity Request Form AKMR 29](#), except for Prisoners who do not require an AKMR29 as anonymity is mandated by policy.
- Clinical or clerical staff to support patient completing the AKMR29 and explain the implications of anonymity.
- Patient must be informed that anonymity results in full suppression of their information – No exceptions or nominated contacts will be accepted.
- Main reception staff will advise all callers/visitors that there is no

patient by this name in the hospital.

- Completed AKMR29 is returned to the clerk to update webPAS refer to [Appendix 1](#).
- Clerk to notify ED/Ward NUM that patient has been designated as anonymous
- Do not send emails advising of an anonymous patient. This is a breach of patient confidentiality.
- Keep original AKMR29 with patient notes for scanning into the DMR.
- Provide a photocopy of AKMR29 to patient.

3.1.2 Discharging an Anonymous Patient

- Upon discharge reset the Privacy Indicator back to blank.
- Exceptions apply to patients, identified as Prisoners or those under the care of the Department of Communities or the Child Protection Unit, their privacy indicator must remain.

3.2 Visitor Restrictions

- Visitor restrictions when put in place block calls and visitors being directed to the patient.
- Clinical staff may request patient's visitors and/or phone calls to be restricted. Clinical staff have a responsibility to advise the patient of this decision.

3.2.1 Activating Visitor Restrictions

- Clerk to update the patient condition on WebPAS as directed by clinical staff refer to [Appendix 2](#).
- The relevant patient condition code will then appear in the column on webPAS when displaying the current admission ward view screen.
- Main reception staff will:
 - Advise visitor that there are no visitors allowed.
 - When receiving a phone call, advise the caller the patient is unable to receive calls.

4. Legislative context

The following documents are required to give effect to this procedure Legislation

- [EMHS Prisoners and Detainees: Management of Policy EMHS:132](#)

5. Compliance, monitoring and evaluation

Compliance against this procedure will be monitored by the Health Information Systems Support Officer, Inpatient Clerical Coordinator and Emergency Department Clerical Coordinator and feedback provided to the clerical staff. Breaches to this procedure will be reviewed by the Manager – Health Information Management Service.

6. Relevant standards

National Safety and Quality Health Service (NSQHS) Standards (second edition):

- Standard 2 – Partnering with Consumers

7. Policy owner (relating to these procedures)

Manager Health Information Management Service

Enquiries relating to this procedure may be directed to:

Title: Manager
 Department: Health Information Management Service
 Email: AHS.HIMSManager@health.wa.gov.au

8. Review

This procedure will be reviewed and evaluated as required to ensure relevance and currency. At a minimum it will be reviewed within one (1) year after first issue and at least every three (3) years thereafter.

Version	Effective from	Effective to	Amendment(s)
V3	15 10 2025	15 10 2028	Scheduled review: title and broken links updated

9. Authorisation

This procedure has been authorised and issued by:

Authorised by	Michael Morton – Director Operations & Corporate Services
Authorisation date	15 10 2025
Published date	15 10 2025

Appendix 1: Activating Anonymity

Activating Anonymity

1. Patient demographic screen – update patient demographics
2. Click on the Privacy Indicator drop down menu
3. Select Anonymous
4. Click update

Note: You will know you have successfully applied the anonymous status when you can view a green padlock on the patient record.

The screenshot displays the patient demographic screen in a web application. At the top, a yellow banner contains the text "DO NOT USE Mr Do Not Use" and a clock icon. Below this, the "Date of Birth" field is highlighted with a red circle. The "Privacy ANO" dropdown menu is also highlighted with a red circle, and the "Anonymous" option is selected. A red arrow points to the "Anonymous" option. The "Demographics Confirmed Date" is 13 Oct 2010. The "U/R Comments" section shows a list of comments: "11 Jul 2018 01:24:54 xRELEASE webPAS Release Instal", "18/10/2017: Patient has Inactive UR D9515014", "4/5/2017: Patient has Inactive U/R K9355465", and "20/3/2017 Patient has inactive UR A9480042". At the bottom, there are buttons for "Update", "Alias", "Alternate ID", "Links", "All Contacts", "Prev Address", "Concession Card", and "Cancel".



Appendix 2: Activating Restrictions

Activating Restrictions

1. Select patient ward
2. Find correct patient – click on patient condition flag
3. The condition flag will open an update screen – tick or untick the visitor/phone calls allowed fields as required – press update **(you will need to cancel out of the screen once you have selected update).**
4. Under the patient condition it will show:

V = Visitors Allowed

R = Restricted Visitors

P = Phone Calls Allowed

N = No Phone Calls Allowed

This information is visible for the reception staff when managing patient enquiries.

Ward	Maud Bellas Ward		Type of Bed	All Beds	Number of Patients	14
Bed	Patient	Patient Condition	Diet	Fasting		
R01 B53	*** Empty ***					
R02 B54	 MATTHEWS, Baby Of Jorja (c5906188) (6m,M,F5908006)	 In Labour (30/11 11:46) [R, P - 4554]				
R03 B55	 HUNTER, Michelle Anne (29y,F,H5908580)	 [V, P - 4555]				
R03 B56	*** Empty ***					
R04 B57	  JENKINS, Pauline (38y,F,K5901916)	 [V, P - 4557]				
R04 B57	  JENKINS, Baby Of Pauline (k5901916 (6m,M,L5908000)	 [R, NI]				

Update Condition - MATTHEWS Mstr Baby Of Jorja (c5906188)

Last Update: 30 Nov 2018 11:46

Condition: In Labour

Ambulatory Status: ☐

Visitors Allowed?: ☐

Phone Calls Allowed?: ☒

Discharge Preparation Status: ☐

Expected Discharge Date: Time:

Comments:

Before referencing this procedure document please ensure that you have the latest version from the [Policy Library](#) information hub page.